OWAIS AHMED SHARIFF

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LinkedIn | GitHub | Website | Medium | TryHackMe

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science (Information Security) *2021 - 2025*

Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), Vellore | CGPA: 8.35

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Optiv Security *Bangalore, India*

Cybersecurity Consultant Jan 2025 - Present

- Led Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM) assessments for top US and Canada financial institutions, independently completing 200+ vendor security assessments evaluating controls against NIST CSF, SOC 2, PCI DSS, and ISO 27001 frameworks to identify risk gaps and drive remediation
- Designed and developed an OSINT threat intelligence platform that automates security exposure assessment across third-party vendors by surfacing leaked credentials, exposed API keys, misconfigurations, and vulnerable dependencies through code repository and web asset analysis
- Analyze compliance framework requirements (NIST CSF, SOC 2, PCI DSS, ISO 27001) to develop Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered platform using GPT-4 and Claude that extracts security insights from vendor documentation, automating risk scoring and control gap identification
- Research threat actor infrastructure and credential exposure patterns, designed Python automation pipelines integrating VirusTotal, Shodan, Censys, and breach database APIs to enrich vendor security profiles and reduce manual investigation time by 70%
- Awarded Star Award (June 2025) for security research automation and OSINT intelligence gathering contributions

L&T Technology Services *Khobar, Saudi Arabia*

Cybersecurity Intern May 2024 - July 2024

- Hardened SCADA/ICS security for critical oil & gas infrastructure via network segmentation and intrusion detection systems
- Deployed Windows Server domain controllers with Active Directory, enforcing least-privilege access policies and audit logging infrastructure
- Conducted incident investigations analyzing Sysmon telemetry, Windows Event Logs, and packet captures to identify lateral movement and privilege escalation attempts
- Co-Authored security policies covering vulnerability management, patch management, and incident response aligned with NIST CSF

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Privacy-Preserving Threat Actor Clustering Pipeline | Provisional Patent Filing

Building a system that correlates threat actor identities across Telegram, dark web forums, and paste sites using behavioral fingerprinting (temporal patterns, writing style, OpSec habits) and clustering algorithms to track campaigns while preserving privacy. Currently filing provisional patent.

Post-Quantum Cryptography for Wireless Standards | VIT Research Project

Analyzed RSA, ECC, and AES vulnerabilities under quantum threat models via Shor's and Grover's algorithms. Evaluated lattice-based (Kyber, Dilithium), hash-based (SPHINCS+), and code-based post-quantum schemes for wireless standards, focusing on performance trade-offs in resource-constrained IoT environments.

KEY PROJECTS

Hog C2: Command & Control Framework with Notion Integration | GitHub
Conducted vulnerability research demonstrating Living Off Trusted Sites (LOTS) technique, successfully exfiltrating data from fully patched Windows 11 systems with enterprise DLP protection. Designed CASB detection module using behavioral analytics algorithms to identify anomalous API patterns and mapped coverage to MITRE ATT&CK (T1071.001).

Rust-Based Credential Leak & Secrets Scanner | GitHub
Developed high-performance scanner achieving 500+ MB/s throughput to detect exposed credentials across codebases and cloud infrastructure, discovering 150+ exposed secrets and mapping them to attack paths (MITRE ATT&CK T1552).

AdVison: Visual Prompt Injection Research Platform | GitHub
Built and published a free interactive research platform demonstrating how hidden text, subtle contrast shifts, and adversarial visual cues can exploit visual prompt injection vulnerabilities in multimodal AI models (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini). Platform lets security researchers explore pixel-level attacks against AI vision systems hands-on. Featured in Adversarial AI Digest security newsletter (October 2025).

SKILLS

Compliance & GRC:	NIST CSF, SOC 2, PCI DSS, ISO 27001, Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM), vendor risk assessment, control gap analysis, risk scoring, audit preparation, policy development
Threat Research:	Malware analysis, adversary tracking, C2 development, CASB detection engineering, vulnerability research, dark web OSINT, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, IOC enrichment
Reverse Engineering:	Ghidra, x64dbg, PE analysis, static/dynamic analysis
Programming:	Python, TypeScript, Go, Bash, PowerShell, SQL
Security Tools:	Wireshark, Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Sysmon, Splunk, QRadar, ELK Stack, Snort, Nessus, Autopsy, Shodan, Censys, Hydra, John the Ripper, Hashcat, YARA
Security Automation:	LLM-powered analysis, GPT-4/Claude API integration, automated IOC enrichment, scraper generation, security workflow automation, Flask, FastAPI, Docker
Platforms:	Linux (Kali, Ubuntu, RHEL), Windows Server, Active Directory, Git/GitHub, AWS, Azure

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH v12)** | EC-Council
- **CompTIA Security+** | CompTIA
- **ISO 27001:2022 Lead Auditor** | Information Security Management Systems
- **Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)** | Microsoft

ACHIEVEMENTS & RECOGNITION

- Star Award, Optiv Security (June 2025) for security research automation and threat intelligence
- Ranked in Top 3% on TryHackMe CTF Platform
- Merit Scholarship, Vellore Institute of Technology